

M19 Protected Review & Repair

OPEN ONLY AFTER SAVED FIRST ATTEMPT

Standalone Zero-to-Job-Ready Data Engineer 2026 | M19

Protection rule

This review is diagnosis material, not first-pass teaching. Open only after saving the independent attempt. After repair, close this pack and use the fresh changed retest.

Mastery rule

No score percentage creates mastery. Every required competency must be independently usable and no critical failure may remain.

DE19-01 Review - Truthful one-page Data Engineer resume

Expected reasoning

Evidence -> action -> system -> validation/result. Example: Built a Python ingestion pipeline that quarantines invalid rows and proved idempotent reruns with unchanged trusted counts.

Check these dimensions

- Truthful/factual: every claim is supportable.
- Technical: grain/behavior/failure model is correct.
- Validation: at least one independent check or evidence path exists.
- Communication: answer is concise enough to deliver without reading.
- Transfer: fresh retest uses changed details rather than memorized wording.

Likely repair

If weak, repair only the failed dimension. Common trap: Inventing employment, years of experience, production scale, users, revenue impact, certifications or cloud runtime you did not actually have.

Fresh route

Close Review and open 06_FRESH_RETEST/RETEST_DE19-01.md.

DE19-02 Review - GitHub and project portfolio final polish

Expected reasoning

Pinned repo -> README -> architecture -> setup -> test/evidence -> failure/recovery -> limitations.

Check these dimensions

- Truthful/factual: every claim is supportable.
- Technical: grain/behavior/failure model is correct.
- Validation: at least one independent check or evidence path exists.
- Communication: answer is concise enough to deliver without reading.
- Transfer: fresh retest uses changed details rather than memorized wording.

Likely repair

If weak, repair only the failed dimension. Common trap: Polished screenshots with broken setup, copied tutorial repos, hidden secrets, dead files, or claims that exceed executed evidence.

Fresh route

Close Review and open 06_FRESH_RETEST/RETEST_DE19-02.md.

DE19-03 Review - LinkedIn/professional profile without overclaiming

Expected reasoning

Target role + defensible stack + strongest proof + current availability. Keep claims narrow enough to defend in a live interview.

Check these dimensions

- Truthful/factual: every claim is supportable.
- Technical: grain/behavior/failure model is correct.
- Validation: at least one independent check or evidence path exists.
- Communication: answer is concise enough to deliver without reading.
- Transfer: fresh retest uses changed details rather than memorized wording.

Likely repair

If weak, repair only the failed dimension. Common trap: Using “Data Engineer at X” when you are not employed there, invented years, or stuffing every technology name into the headline.

Fresh route

Close Review and open 06_FRESH_RETEST/RETEST_DE19-03.md.

DE19-04 Review - Degree-aware job targeting: apply/skip rules

Expected reasoning

APPLY when core work matches and hard requirements are met; MAYBE when a gap is preferred/trainable; SKIP when a hard legal/degree/experience requirement clearly excludes you.

Check these dimensions

- Truthful/factual: every claim is supportable.
- Technical: grain/behavior/failure model is correct.
- Validation: at least one independent check or evidence path exists.
- Communication: answer is concise enough to deliver without reading.
- Transfer: fresh retest uses changed details rather than memorized wording.

Likely repair

If weak, repair only the failed dimension. Common trap: Mass-applying to roles requiring unrelated seniority or mandatory qualifications, then misreading rejections as proof the field is closed.

Fresh route

Close Review and open 06_FRESH_RETEST/RETEST_DE19-04.md.

DE19-05 Review - SQL interview drills

Expected reasoning

Question -> state grain -> write query -> inspect duplicates/nulls -> validate with an independent count/total -> explain trade-off.

Check these dimensions

- Truthful/factual: every claim is supportable.
- Technical: grain/behavior/failure model is correct.
- Validation: at least one independent check or evidence path exists.
- Communication: answer is concise enough to deliver without reading.
- Transfer: fresh retest uses changed details rather than memorized wording.

Likely repair

If weak, repair only the failed dimension. Common trap: A query that runs but has wrong join cardinality, denominator, filter timing or nondeterministic ranking.

Fresh route

Close Review and open 06_FRESH_RETEST/RETEST_DE19-05.md.

DE19-06 Review - Python interview drills

Expected reasoning

Input contract -> transform -> explicit failure path -> deterministic output -> edge-case tests -> complexity at a practical level.

Check these dimensions

- Truthful/factual: every claim is supportable.
- Technical: grain/behavior/failure model is correct.
- Validation: at least one independent check or evidence path exists.
- Communication: answer is concise enough to deliver without reading.
- Transfer: fresh retest uses changed details rather than memorized wording.

Likely repair

If weak, repair only the failed dimension. Common trap: Silent dropping, mutable hidden state, catching every exception, or code that cannot be explained line by line.

Fresh route

Close Review and open 06_FRESH_RETEST/RETEST_DE19-06.md.

DE19-07 Review - Data-engineering concepts and troubleshooting drills

Expected reasoning

Symptom -> blast radius -> first evidence -> likely layer -> smallest safe test -> repair -> rerun boundary -> reconciliation -> prevention.

Check these dimensions

- Truthful/factual: every claim is supportable.
- Technical: grain/behavior/failure model is correct.
- Validation: at least one independent check or evidence path exists.
- Communication: answer is concise enough to deliver without reading.
- Transfer: fresh retest uses changed details rather than memorized wording.

Likely repair

If weak, repair only the failed dimension. Common trap: Restarting/deleting/reprocessing everything before understanding persisted state, or claiming a cause without logs/metrics/data evidence.

Fresh route

Close Review and open 06_FRESH_RETEST/RETEST_DE19-07.md.

DE19-08 Review - Project walkthrough interview

Expected reasoning

Problem -> sources -> architecture -> grain -> quality -> idempotency -> orchestration -> failure/recovery -> security
-> limitations -> 10x change.

Check these dimensions

- Truthful/factual: every claim is supportable.
- Technical: grain/behavior/failure model is correct.
- Validation: at least one independent check or evidence path exists.
- Communication: answer is concise enough to deliver without reading.
- Transfer: fresh retest uses changed details rather than memorized wording.

Likely repair

If weak, repair only the failed dimension. Common trap: Reciting README buzzwords, reading code to remember basic design, or saying “production-ready” without production evidence.

Fresh route

Close Review and open 06_FRESH_RETEST/RETEST_DE19-08.md.

DE19-09 Review - Architecture/system-design defense for junior roles

Expected reasoning

Requirements -> scale/latency -> source contracts -> storage/compute -> orchestration -> correctness -> security -> observability -> failure modes -> cost/operability.

Check these dimensions

- Truthful/factual: every claim is supportable.
- Technical: grain/behavior/failure model is correct.
- Validation: at least one independent check or evidence path exists.
- Communication: answer is concise enough to deliver without reading.
- Transfer: fresh retest uses changed details rather than memorized wording.

Likely repair

If weak, repair only the failed dimension. Common trap: Choosing Kafka/Spark/Kubernetes by default when batch SQL/Python would meet the requirement more safely.

Fresh route

Close Review and open 06_FRESH_RETEST/RETEST_DE19-09.md.

DE19-10 Review - Behavioral answers and career-transition story

Expected reasoning

Context -> responsibility -> action -> result -> verification -> reflection. Use course/project facts if you do not yet have professional DE experience.

Check these dimensions

- Truthful/factual: every claim is supportable.
- Technical: grain/behavior/failure model is correct.
- Validation: at least one independent check or evidence path exists.
- Communication: answer is concise enough to deliver without reading.
- Transfer: fresh retest uses changed details rather than memorized wording.

Likely repair

If weak, repair only the failed dimension. Common trap: Invented workplace stories, blaming teammates/tools, or giving a perfect story with no decision, result or lesson.

Fresh route

Close Review and open 06_FRESH_RETEST/RETEST_DE19-10.md.

DE19-11 Review - Technical English: explain code, failures and decisions clearly

Expected reasoning

State what the object is, what changed, why, how you checked it, and one way it can fail.

Check these dimensions

- Truthful/factual: every claim is supportable.
- Technical: grain/behavior/failure model is correct.
- Validation: at least one independent check or evidence path exists.
- Communication: answer is concise enough to deliver without reading.
- Transfer: fresh retest uses changed details rather than memorized wording.

Likely repair

If weak, repair only the failed dimension. Common trap: Long definitions with no concrete example, rushing when stuck, or hiding uncertainty instead of correcting yourself calmly.

Fresh route

Close Review and open 06_FRESH_RETEST/RETEST_DE19-11.md.

DE19-12 Review - Application tracker, feedback loop and weekly repair cycle

Expected reasoning

Targeted role -> truthful application -> screen -> assessment -> technical -> final -> offer. Record stage-specific failure patterns and run one repair experiment per batch.

Check these dimensions

- Truthful/factual: every claim is supportable.
- Technical: grain/behavior/failure model is correct.
- Validation: at least one independent check or evidence path exists.
- Communication: answer is concise enough to deliver without reading.
- Transfer: fresh retest uses changed details rather than memorized wording.

Likely repair

If weak, repair only the failed dimension. Common trap: No tracker, repeated chasing, mass ineligible applications, or endless course polishing instead of testing the market.

Fresh route

Close Review and open 06_FRESH_RETEST/RETEST_DE19-12.md.

DE19-13 Review - Timed coding test: arrays, strings and hash-map problems

Expected reasoning

Restate contract -> examples -> choose data structure -> implement -> edge cases -> complexity -> verbal explanation.

Check these dimensions

- Truthful/factual: every claim is supportable.
- Technical: grain/behavior/failure model is correct.
- Validation: at least one independent check or evidence path exists.
- Communication: answer is concise enough to deliver without reading.
- Transfer: fresh retest uses changed details rather than memorized wording.

Likely repair

If weak, repair only the failed dimension. Common trap: Memorizing solutions, ignoring empty/duplicate cases, or using an $O(n^2)$ pattern without noticing when a hash map gives a clearer $O(n)$ approach.

Fresh route

Close Review and open 06_FRESH_RETEST/RETEST_DE19-13.md.

DE19-14 Review - Combined SQL + Python interview simulation

Expected reasoning

Save first attempt -> classify misses -> open review -> repair exact competency -> close review -> fresh changed mixed mock -> defend without notes.

Check these dimensions

- Truthful/factual: every claim is supportable.
- Technical: grain/behavior/failure model is correct.
- Validation: at least one independent check or evidence path exists.
- Communication: answer is concise enough to deliver without reading.
- Transfer: fresh retest uses changed details rather than memorized wording.

Likely repair

If weak, repair only the failed dimension. Common trap: Repeating the same mock after reading answers and calling recognition "mastery".

Fresh route

Close Review and open 06_FRESH_RETEST/RETEST_DE19-14.md.